FORENSICS / INCIDENT ANALYSIS

AI Incident Brief

Rules engine

ledger-validator-02 · 172.16.2.19

01 Summary

ledger-validator-02 (172.16.2.19) reported ledger / data tampering at Frankfurt, Germany, FRA-DC1 - EU Banking VPC, Floor 2, Rack 04, U16. Hash mismatch on /var/data/ledger.db: expected 7f4b8c93a120ee61, observed 9a1e32bd7810fa42. The alert was detected at 18 Oct 2026, 12:02:00 (Europe/Berlin site-local); 2026-10-18 10:02:00 UTC.

02 Evidence

Recorded facts

> Hash mismatch on /var/data/ledger.db: expected 7f4b8c93a120ee61, observed 9a1e32bd7810fa42.
>
> `telemetry.ledger.fileHash` 2026-10-18 10:02:00 UTC

> PID 9104 wrote /var/data/ledger.db outside the authorized writer policy.
>
> `auditd.fileWrite` 2026-10-18 10:01:46 UTC

> 1 of 5 peer checksums matched /var/data/ledger.db.
>
> `consensus.replicaHash` 2026-10-18 10:02:15 UTC

03 ATT&CK mapping

T1565.001 · Stored Data Manipulation ↗ (https://attack.mitre.org/techniques/T1565/001/) Confidence: High

Impact · 3 independent matching sensors

Matched because Hash mismatch on /var/data/ledger.db: expected 7f4b8c93a120ee61, observed 9a1e32bd7810fa42. PID 9104 wrote /var/data/ledger.db outside the authorized writer policy. 1 of 5 peer checksums matched /var/data/ledger.db.

Confidence: 1 independent matching sensor is Low, 2 Medium, 3 or more High.

04 Likely intent

Analysis (inference)

> *The changed stored data may indicate an attempt to alter records or their audit trail. A legitimate write or storage fault still needs to be ruled out.*

05 Blast radius

Shared infrastructure indicates potential exposure, not confirmed compromise.

Cluster	VPC

EU Banking VPC

vpc-fac-fra-01

Facility

FRA-DC1 - EU Banking VPC

Country

Germany

eu-fintech-gateway

Cluster / VPC / Facility / Country

Healthy ↗

06 Recommended actions

Analyst checklist. Actions are never executed automatically.

1. **Isolate Node from Cluster**

   Review the impact and confirm quarantine using the existing node control.

2. ☑ **Preserve forensic snapshot**

   Preserve the relevant files, process metadata and logs before making further changes.

3. ☐ **Compare with a verified ledger copy**

   Compare affected files and peer replicas against a trusted checkpoint; preserve the current copy before any recovery.

4. ☐ **Review connections to neighbouring nodes**

   Review access and connection logs for the shared infrastructure shown below. Shared location alone does not prove spread.

07 Timeline

`2026-10-18 09:59:00 UTC` `180s before alert`

Scheduled ledger checksum matched the trusted checkpoint.

ledger-verifier

`2026-10-18 10:01:46 UTC` `14s before alert`

PID 9104 wrote /var/data/ledger.db outside the authorized writer policy.

auditd

`2026-10-18 10:02:00 UTC` `Alert`

Ledger file checksum mismatch raised the integrity alert.

ledger-verifier

`2026-10-18 10:02:15 UTC` `15s after alert`

Only one of five peer checksums matched the local ledger.

replica-monitor

`2026-10-18 10:02:30 UTC` `30s after alert`

Integrity alert entered the analyst queue; containment is pending.

incident-router

Telemetry snapshot: 2026-10-18 10:08:00 UTC

Prepared locally from the selected incident. Validate inferences before responding.